



Parent Handbook

Updated February 2025

Bell

16809 N. Park Pl.
Glendale, AZ 85306
Ph: 602.843.2485

Monday - Friday
6:00am - 6:00pm

Olive

6145 W. Olive Ave.
Glendale, AZ 85302
Ph: 623.777.0113

Monday - Friday
6:00am - 6:00pm

Mesa

2717 S Alma School Rd.
Mesa, AZ 85210
Ph: 480-222-8484

Monday - Friday
5:30am - 6:00pm

McDowell

1616 N. 89th Ave.
Phoenix, AZ 85037
Ph: 623.936.1186

Monday - Friday
5:30am - 6:00pm



Raising
Arizona
PRESCHOOL

General Information

Hours of Operation

Bell & Olive:

Monday – Friday
6:00am – 6:00pm

McDowell & Mesa:

Monday – Friday
5:30am – 6:00pm

10 hour per day limit

Registration Fee

One Time Fee: \$100 or \$150/family

Activity Fee

There is a \$20.00 Activity Fee each month for supplies such as Markers, Crayons, paper etc. which is NOT included in the price above. This will be applied the first FULL week of each month.

Payment

- All families are required to fill out our Autopay form. We use Procure for all payments.
- Checking accounts are preferred. There will be a 3% fee added for card payment.
- Cash & checks are not accepted.

Full Time Rates

Program	Weekly Rate
Infants (Mesa only)	\$295
One year (walking) – Two years	\$265
Preschool/Pre-K (3-5 years)	\$225
School age (school year)	\$125
School age (5-12 years)	\$195
Daily rate (if space available)	\$95

Communication

Mission Statement

At Raising Arizona Preschool (RAP), we consider it our great privilege to teach the children of America. Children in every sense are our future. Our school is built to inspire and develop future leaders. We try each and every day to inspire wonder and thought, not through vain repetition, but through curiosity, play and experimentation. We believe learning is not about filling an empty vessel, but about kindling a fire within a young mind. We believe that children do not care what you know until they know that you care about them, so each day starts and ends with developing a caring relationship with your children. We believe through mindfulness and meditation that we can help children learn self-regulation techniques to make them more successful in all aspects of life.

Description of Services

We provide childcare services for ages one years old and walking to twelve years of age. Activities revolve around the curriculum that is set forth in every classroom. Teachers strive to educate through interactive learning, play and structure. Our staff is put through a minimum of 24 hours of continual training every year. All staff members are CPR and First Aid certified, holds a valid fingerprint clearance card and are thoroughly background checked. We feel that working hand in hand with parents is the key to complementing a child's routine at home while they are in our care. All programs are specifically designed to enhance your child's emotional, intellectual, social and physical abilities. Children will be taught basic Math, beginning reading skills, mindfulness to teach them how to handle and talk about their emotions, learn basic Science and be hands on with activities each week.

Our goal throughout the whole school is to educate children and love them as if they were our own. As your child grows and travels through each room, they are preparing for kindergarten. Raising Arizona Preschool is a passageway to your child's future. Together, we are writing your child's first chapter of life. If you would like more information or have specific questions, our Directors will provide you with any information you seek.

Hours of Operation

We are open Monday through Friday from 6:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. Parents/Guardians have access to our facility at any time during hours of operation. We are closed on the following holidays: New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Fourth of July, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, Christmas Eve and Christmas Day. If a holiday falls on a weekend, we will close on that Friday or Monday. We reserve the right to close the center if not enough children are signed up to be in attendance for the day. We will give plenty of notice for any in-service days or other early closure days.

Drop Off/Pick Up Etiquette

All children must arrive before 10:30 am for the following locations Bell, Olive, and McDowell. Our Mesa location has a drop off time of 10:00 am. Drop off/Pick up time parents spend in the classroom should be kept to a minimum. No longer than 10 minutes should be spend dropping off/picking up your child(ren). If you need an extended time to talk to the teacher, please talk to one the directors to schedule a meeting.

Child Admission & Release

Children enrolled must be signed into the Childcare Center by an authorized person over 18 years of age using the QR code scanner. MUST be parent/guardian's FULL LEGAL signature. Failure to sign your legal signature will accrue a \$10 fee. Children will only be released to a parent, legal guardian or those authorized on the Emergency and Immunization Record Card. ID is required to ensure that the person on the emergency card is the authorized person picking up the child, if they are not set up for our fingerprint system. If someone other than those specified should be picking up a child, the office will need to be notified, either in person with written notice or a phone call. We require first and last name of those picking up a child; a valid current photo I.D will also need to be presented at the time of pickup. In the event that an unauthorized person tries to pick up a child it is our policy to call 9-1-1 and then the parent or legal guardian. If you have a custody agreement, the childcare center must have a copy on file.

Parent Security System

Each parent or authorized person(s) to pick up children will receive a four-digit security door code. Security codes are not shared from parent to parent. If a person comes in and does not have a code, they will be asked to show picture I.D. to verify they are an authorized person for pick up. A staff member will let them in accordingly. These systems are in place to ensure the safety of the children enrolled.

Sick/Illness Policy

All children who are showing signs of illness will be refused to attend. A doctor's release may be necessary for the child to return. Parents will agree not to bring their child to Raising Arizona knowing they are sick. If a child is running a fever, they may not return until they have been fever free for a 24 hour period without the use of medication.

If your child shows any of the following symptoms: Fever, Diarrhea, Vomiting, Infectious Sores, Excessive Tiredness, loss or change of color, child not acting like themselves, eye discharge, lice (must have no nits, eggs, bugs), etc... Please note that this is not a complete list. If any of these symptoms are exhibited, a parent will be called and will need to pick their child up immediately (must be within 1 hour). If there is a Covid diagnosis for the child or someone within the same household. The child may not return until 5 days of the last symptom of the person who tested positive.

We will alert all parents if any children have a contagious illness. Please note we are not trying to make any parent miss work but we are preventing the illness from affecting the other children in our care. Again, all children must be symptom free for 24 hours without the use of any medication before returning to our facility.

Medication Policy

RAP does NOT store medication for "just in case use". We can administer some forms of medication with a 'Medication Consent Form'. All medication must be in its original packaging and not expired. Breathing machines are okay with a doctor's note of the uses needed. If your child has asthma, we require an "Asthma Action Plan" from your physician. If an epi-pen is necessary, please get an action plan from your doctor to bring in. If a non-life-threatening medication has to be used for more than 5 days, we will require a doctor's visit and note to continue the medication (cough medicine, Tylenol, Ibuprofen).

Accident Procedures

If your child is involved in an accident, the following steps will be taken: The injury will be assessed, a staff member will take Action to Aid the ailment, tend to the wound and give extra love. A description of the injury will be recorded through our app for the parent/guardian to view. Parents will be contacted by phone if injury or medical needs are severe. If a serious medical situation occurs, 911 will be called then parents/guardians.

Personal Items

We do not allow items from home. To avoid your child's personal items from being lost, please place your child's first and last name on the item as well as talk to them about the appropriate times to have it out during class (i.e., show and share). If the child's personal belongings are lost or broken, Raising Arizona is not responsible, and we will not replace or reimburse the cost. Please do not bring meaningful items to school that can not be replaced. Things do get lost. It is your responsibility to ensure that your child's items are labeled clearly and the teacher knows about them. RAP will not replace broken or lost items.

Insurance Policy

Raising Arizona Preschool maintains General Liability Insurance and when a vehicle is in use, Transportation Vehicle Insurance that exceeds the required limits. The Facility also offers Child Accident Insurance for all children enrolled in our program. A copy of this insurance policy is available upon request.

Pesticide Procedures

We receive a pesticide application as needed. Notices of pesticide spray will be posted in the lobby 48 hours before the application and a specific posting of what pesticide was applied will be posted for 48 hours after each application. Pesticide application reports are available upon request.

Smoke/Alcohol Free Environment

Smoking, tobacco, and alcohol use are not permitted on property. We will not release a child into anyone's care who we believe may be under the influence of drugs or alcohol.

Meals & Snack Schedule

RAP participates in the Children and Adult Childcare federal food program. Our menu rotates on a five week schedule and is regulated by the food program to ensure that your child receives healthy, good quality meals and snacks. Meals and snacks are served at the same time daily and our menus are posted in the front lobby. Please let us know if your child has any allergies and we will accommodate them to the best of our ability. **We ask that you do not bring any outside food into the preschool.** Our Food Program requires that each family submit a CACFP Food Affidavit form. If we do not receive this form, you will have to pay for meals.

- Breakfast is 7:30am - 9:00am
- Lunch is 11:30am - 12:30pm
- P.M. Snack is 3:00pm - 4:30pm

An allergy list is posted in the kitchen and all classrooms at all times for added safety!

All of our facilities are peanut free, as needed, per the allergies of our students.

Procure App

Every parent is required to download our Procure App when enrolling their child. This is the main form of communication to relay information about your child's day. It shows what and how much they ate, activities they did throughout the day, provide pictures and more. Please keep in mind that the children are our first priority and the app may not be updated on some occasions or at the same time each day. As a parent, you can also use the message feature in the app and talk to your child's teachers. They will respond mostly during nap time so they can keep all of their attention on your child. The Directors will receive the messages as well. This is not a "live feed" but the app will inform you when the information has been updated.

Required Forms & Documents

We require the enrollment packet to be filled out in its entirety. There may be additional forms we will require for programs associated with Quality First and other programs that we participate in. Immunizations are required or a religious/medical exemption form. It is your responsibility to update the immunization record when your child receives new vaccines. All forms must be updated annually.

Communication

Communication is the most vital part of our preschool. We want your child or children to feel like they are at home while away from home. We want to build and maintain strong relationships. At RAP, we offer an open-door policy with our parents that allow you to call or stop by any time you would like to check on your child or just spend some time in the classroom with them. We encourage parent involvement and love when parents are able to participate. We also encourage parents to communicate with our Directors about the things they enjoy as well as dislike in our program. We love to hear from the parents so that we know where our strengths and weaknesses are. We take all suggestions and will make any necessary changes to better suit the children and the school.

We pride ourselves on making sure that your child or children experiences a positive and encouraging learning environment that will foster happiness and health, and we want children to look forward to coming to school. If a problem should arise, please be sure to let us know as soon as possible so that we can work together on the resolution.

Health Inspections

We maintain current inspection reports, which are available upon request. We are also contracted with the Department of Economic Security and ACCEPT DES subsidy. Raising Arizona Preschool is regulated by the Arizona Department of Health Services. ADHS may be contacted at:

Arizona Department of Health Services

150 North 18th Ave
Suite 400
Phoenix, Arizona 85007
(602)364-2539

Cell Phones

Each child is important and loves your attention. We strongly urge you to remain off your phone during drop off and pick up. Instead ask about their day and what they learned.

Parent Conduct

At RAP, any parent, guardian, or authorized person is expected to conduct themselves in an appropriate and kind manner around children and staff members. Any foul or abusive language, harassment, threatening behavior or physical abuse will lead to the adult not being allowed on campus. Parents/guardians will have to make alternate arrangements for a child to be dropped off and picked up by someone else.

By signing I understand what is expected of me to communicate efficiently with Raising Arizona Preschool regarding my child(ren). I have read each policy in the Communication Section.

Parent Name (Printed)

Parent Signature

Date

Accounting

Payments & Payment Methods

Payments shall not exceed a two-week period. Payments are due on MONDAY'S BEFORE care. After a balance carries for more than two weeks, Raising Arizona will discontinue services until the balance is paid in full. There is a \$20.00 Activity Fee per child due the first full week of each month.

Raising Arizona Preschool requires the use of Autopay through Procare. We must have a valid card or checking account on file. Autopay runs weekly on Monday for the current week or Friday's. We accept ALL major credit cards and checking accounts. Checking accounts are preferred. You will be charged a 3% fee for card payment. There is a \$35.00 decline fee.

Fee Assistance

For those who qualify, there is an assistance program through the Arizona State Department of Economic Security. They will help pay for a portion of your childcare tuition. You are responsible for any extra charges on top of your DES or Quality First Scholarship copay.

Late Fees

Late fees will be applied when your child is left here after our hours of operation. All families should be out of the facility by 6:00pm. There is a \$5.00 charge PER MINUTE, PER CHILD. Upon the third late pick up, you will be asked to find other childcare arrangements for your child. If you are late more than 3 times in one month, you may be asked to change your child's schedule, make other pick up arrangements or withdraw your child(ren). So please pick your child(ren) up on time.

Refunds

Raising Arizona Preschool will only refund if the amount paid exceeds the payment required. There are NO other refunds given. If you fail to notify us that you withdrew your child, no refund will be given.

Parent or Guardian Liability

Should we be forced to pursue collection of any balance due from services rendered, the parent or legal guardian will be held responsible for all expenses for collection including but not limited to attorney's fees, collection fees, late fees, as well as the original balance due.

Signing In & Out

Signing your child In and Out is required by the Arizona Department of Childcare Licensing. We use a digital QR code for signing in and out. MUST be parent/guardian's FULL LEGAL signature. If you fail to sign your child in/out, you will be charged a \$5.00 fee per missing check in/out. This will be added to your next week's payment (billed separately).

Schedule

Only full time care is guaranteed. Any part time children must come on their scheduled days. If you fail to bring your child on their scheduled days (add days or change days without approval), you will be charged a \$55 fee per additional day. This will be added to your next week's payment (billed separately). We charge according to the schedule you fill out for your child (up to 10 hours max). Anything outside that schedule will be up to \$5 per additional hour. In addition, anything over 10 hours will result in an additional fee up to \$5 per hour.

Withdrawal Policy

Parents may withdrawal their child from RAP with Written or e-mail notification. We do ask for two weeks' notice but understand that things do happen, and you may not be able to give us two weeks. If notice was not put in writing or e-mail, we will bill you for an additional two weeks of childcare (all at once) and actions will be taken to collect payment. We do ask that you to fill out a disenrollment form and brief survey about how you liked our services.

Dis-Enrollment & Reinstatement Policy

We recognize that in some cases the environment may not suit you or your child's needs; therefore, we do reserve the right to discontinue a child's enrollment at any time, for any reason. A child may be reinstated providing space is available. All enrollment fees will be reapplied and due upon first day of reinstatement. Please see BEE-HAVIOR Plan in this packet.

By signing I understand Raising Arizona Preschool's fees and charges regarding my child(ren). I have read each policy in the Accounting Section.

Parent Name (Printed)

Parent Signature

Date

Behavior

Room Transitions

As your child ages, we will slowly transition them as needed and as classroom openings become available.

Discipline Guidelines

RAP uses a three step system that combines communication, re-direction and a positive spin on “time-out” called “time-in”. We will first give the child a verbal warning by dropping down to the child’s eye level and asking them to stop the action they are doing. Next, we will again drop to the child’s eye level, and re-direct them to a new activity. If the first two steps do not work, then the child will be placed in a “Quiet Time in”. The child can do a quiet activity with a teacher for a few minutes until they are ready to come back and try again. There is NO form of Corporal Punishment. If negative behavior continues over time, we will schedule a parent teacher conference to discuss options, which may include suspension or discontinuation of services. We strongly feel that there are no bad children, just bad behaviors that can be re-directed into positive ones if parents and teachers work together.

Behaviors & Biting

We will do our best to work with children who are displaying difficult behaviors. However, there are rare situations that arise where the child may need to be removed from our care. We will first try to work together with the child and parents along with the teachers. We reserve the right to disenroll a child from our center if they are hurting other children or staff.

School Age Attendance

If your child is not able to go to elementary school due to suspension or illness. They will not be able to attend RAP during that time.

Transportation

We provide transportation for our school age children to and from certain schools that fit with our schedule. We only drop off and pick up for the start and end times for schools. RAP does not transport for special activities (sports, detention, special events etc.) Please inquire at the site, what schools we will be transporting to and from. All school age children who are transported must sign the van safety rules prior to travel, as well as parents. Any child(ren) who misbehave in the van may result in loss of transportation. Parents/guardians must contact RAP for any changes in Drop Off, Pick Up or absences. Failure to do so will result in a \$10 charge.

Field Trips

RAP may have supervised field trips at scheduled times. A permission slip must be filled out by the parent for the child to participate. Fees may apply and must be paid before the field trip. All safety rules must be followed on field trips. If your child(ren) does not follow direction and safety procedures during a field trip, we will call and have that child picked up from the field trip. Depending on the severity of the behavior, your child may not be able to attend future field trips. In the event they can’t attend field trips due to behavior, they will not be able to attend for that day. Fees for field trips will be added to your weekly tuition.

Bee-havioral Plan

For a more detailed description of the behavioral steps, please see the BEE-HAVIORAL Plan in this packet. This plan is put in place for the safety and best care for your child and all the children in the school. If you refuse to participate in the steps listed in the 'Bee-Havioral' Plan, We reserve the right to withdraw your child. We will give a 5-day notice for their last day.

Mindful Mornings

We believe that the most important thing we can teach our students is emotional regulation. RAP has a unique approach in how we teach this concept. The first tool we use is breathing. We will teach your student how to take deep breaths, and control their breathing when they're upset.

The second tool is gratitude. We encourage our students to appreciate and be grateful for the things we have. It is our belief that that more grateful we are, the happier we are.

The third and final tool is affirmations. Affirmations are powerful, positive phrases that can change the way we view ourselves and our environment. We say our daily affirmations every morning as we start our day.

Final Note

If you have read this entire packet, great job! Now to reward you for your diligence in reading all this important, but boring stuff - bring us a paper airplane and we will waive your registration fee!

By signing I understand Raising Arizona Preschool's fees and charges regarding my child(ren). I have read each policy in the Behavior Section.

Parent Name (Printed)

Parent Signature

Date



The Five Bees of Raising Arizona Preschool

Bee Loving

We will love your child
like our own

Bee Prepared

We will plan out every
day, every hour we will
be prepared

Bee Loyal

We will be loyal to our
school and families here

Bee Happy

We will choose to be
happy every day

Bee Consistent

We will always be consistent,
no matter what is going on in
our personal lives

Child Permission Form

Child's Name

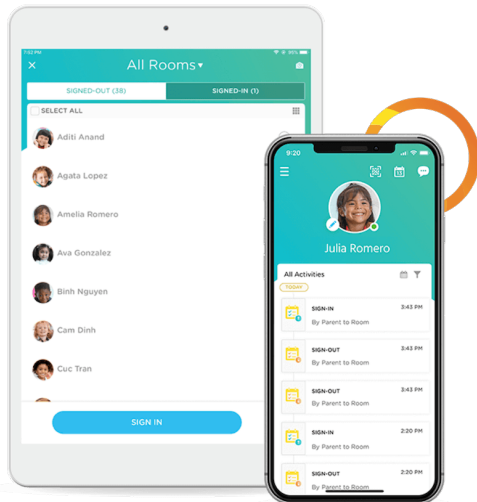
Date

Photograph/Video Release

I give the Raising Arizona Staff permission to take pictures and video of my child for classroom (i.e. decoration use, cubbies, observations etc), internet, advertising & Procure use.

Parent Signature

Date



Daily Communication Through Procure

- **Daily Updates:** Feed of activities throughout the day
- **Photos:** Watch your child's day unfold with snapshots delivered to your mobile device
- **Stay Connected:** Stay in touch with your teacher and strengthen school learning with activities at home.

Procure App

Every parent is required to download our Procure App when enrolling their child. This is the main form of communication to relay information about your child's day. It shows what and how much they ate, activities they did throughout the day, provide pictures and more. Please keep in mind that the children are our

first priority and the app may not be updated on some occasions or at the same time each day. As a parent, you can also use the message feature in the app and talk to your child's teachers. They will respond mostly during nap time so they can keep all of their attention on your child. The Directors will receive the messages as well. This is not a "live feed" but the app will inform you when the information has been updated.

Please provide your email so that we can invite you to App and keep you up to date on your child's day.

Name

Email Address

Name

Email Address

Name

Email Address

If you need any additional people added, please let us know. You will receive a link from Procure to join our school!

First Day Checklist

Ones & Twos

- ☐ One or two extra outfits
- ☐ Make sure to fill out the “About Me Questionnaire” the best you can. (This will help the teacher understand your child better to make the transition easier) These get updated by you annually.
- ☐ A crib sheet & travel size blanket (Label it with your child’s 1st and last name. These are washed on-site.)
- ☐ Diapers or Pull-Ups (one sleeve is a good start)
- ☐ Wipes (1 box)
- ☐ Label all belongings with their first and last name (there are many of the same jackets and items)
- ☐ A copy of your child’s immunization records (we can make a copy here)
- ☐ A family photo for your child (this helps them transition)

Threes, Fours, Fives

- ☐ One or two extra outfits
- ☐ Make sure to fill out the “About Me Questionnaire” the best you can. (This will help the teacher understand your child better to make the transition easier) These get updated by you annually.
- ☐ A crib sheet and travel size blanket (Label it with your child’s 1st and last name) *These are washed on-site
- ☐ Label all belongings with their first and last name (there are many of the same jackets and items)
- ☐ A copy of your child’s immunization records (we can make a copy here)
- ☐ A family photo for your child (this helps them transition)

Child Schedule

Schedules may not exceed 10 hours. If this can't be avoided a work note from your employer is required and must be updated annually. You will be charged \$5.00 per hour/per child each day over 10 hours. In addition, anything outside of this schedule will be \$5 per hour.

All children must be in attendance by 10:30am.

Child(ren)'s Name(s)

Monday

	am	—		pm
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Tuesday

	am	—		pm
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Wednesday

	am	—		pm
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Thursday

	am	—		pm
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Friday

	am	—		pm
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If your children will have different schedules. Please ask for another one of these forms.

Schedule: Only full time care is guaranteed. Any part time children must come on their scheduled days. If you fail to bring your child on their scheduled days (add days or change days without approval), you will be charged a \$55 fee per additional day. This will be added to your next week's payment (billed separately).

Maximum Hours: Raising Arizona Preschool accepts DES childcare payments. DES requires that your child only come during your work hours and **no more than 10 hours per day**. We are fair to all families and we know sometimes you may work farther away or longer hours. Due to this, if you need your child to stay more than 10 hours in one day, you will be charged \$5.00 per hour/per child. We also will require a work note to show that you work more than 10 hours or that travel time is farther resulting in more than 10 hours in our care.

Parent Name (Printed)

Parent Signature

Date